



# Ethics in Research

## REFERENCES:

- <https://www.apa.org/ethics/code>
- [Katz, J. \(1996\). "The Nuremberg Code and the Nuremberg Trial. A reappraisal". JAMA. 276 \(20\): 1662-6. doi:10.1001/jama.1996.03540200048030. PMID 8922453.](#)
- <https://www.research.uky.edu/uploads/ori-d60000-criteria-irb-approval-guidance-pdf>

# Task:

- In small groups of 4, read through the 10 top unethical experiments.
- <http://listverse.com/2008/09/07/top-10-unethical-psychological-experiments/>
- In your groups, **create a code of ethics that you believe should be followed while doing social science experiments**
  - Examine what was not done in the 10 most unethical experiments as a guide in creating your own code

# What are Research Ethics?

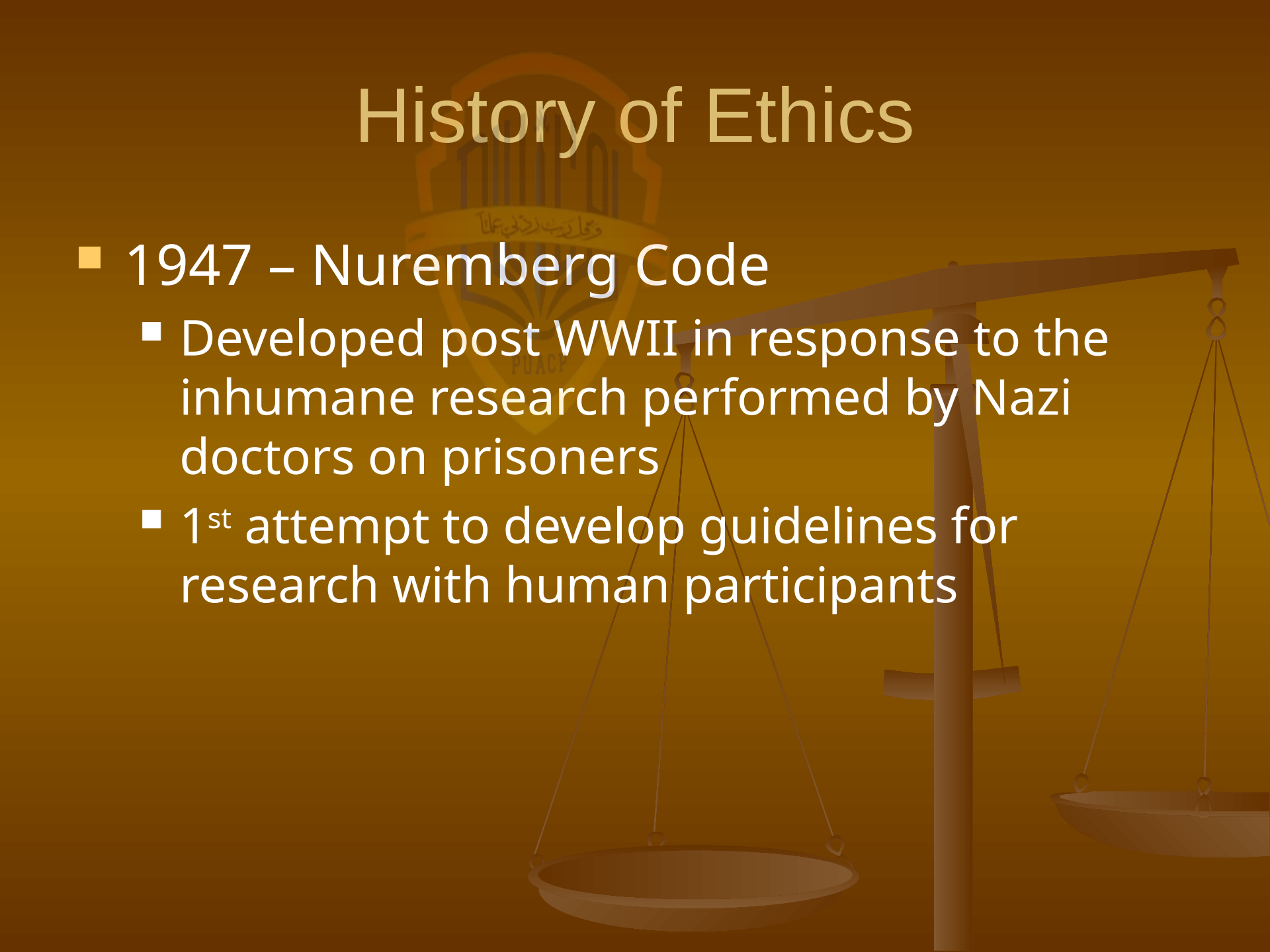
- As in other aspects of business, all parties in research should exhibit ethical behavior. Ethics are norms or standards of behavior that guide moral choices about our behavior and our relationships with others.
- Ethics guide behavior and decisions
- Ethics guide us through a range of concerns, dilemmas, and conflicts
- Social researchers have a clear moral
  - And professional obligation to behave in an ethical manner

# Typology of Legal and Moral Actions in Social Research



|       | ETHICAL           |                     |
|-------|-------------------|---------------------|
|       | Yes               | No                  |
| LEGAL |                   |                     |
| Yes   | Moral and Legal   | Legal but Immoral   |
| No    | Illegal but Moral | Immoral and Illegal |

# History of Ethics

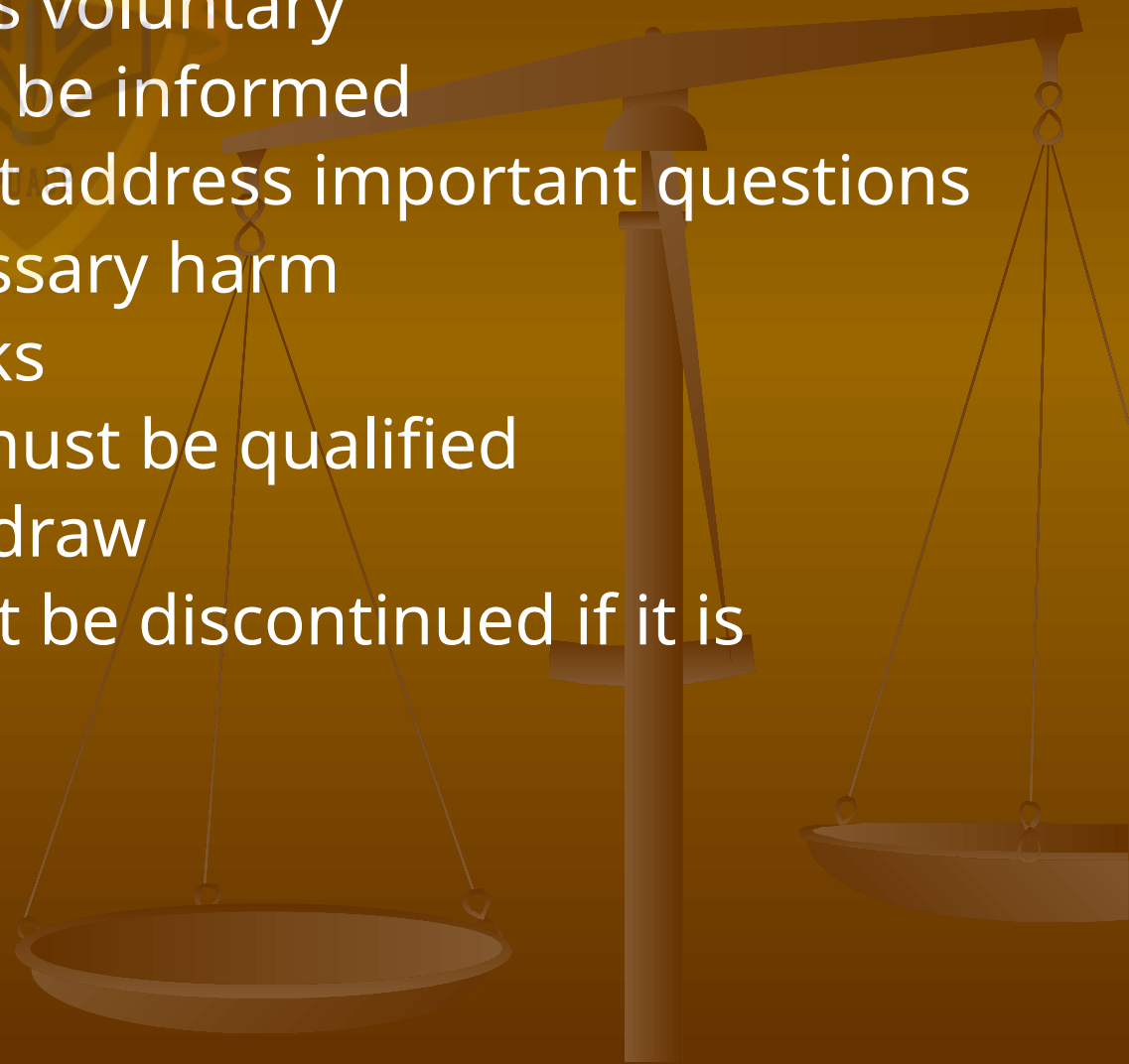
The background of the slide is a solid dark brown color. In the center, there is a faint, large-scale illustration of a balance scale, symbolizing justice or ethics. To the left of the scale, there is a faint, semi-transparent crest or seal of a university, featuring a shield with a book and a banner above it with Arabic script.

- 1947 – Nuremberg Code
  - Developed post WWII in response to the inhumane research performed by Nazi doctors on prisoners
  - 1<sup>st</sup> attempt to develop guidelines for research with human participants

# Nuremberg Code

## ■ Guidelines

- 1) Participation is voluntary
- 2) Subjects must be informed
- 3) Research must address important questions
- 4) Avoid unnecessary harm
- 5) Benefits > Risks
- 6) Researchers must be qualified
- 7) Ability to withdraw
- 8) Research must be discontinued if it is harmful



# Protection of Human Rights - IRB

- Institutional Review Board (IRB)
  - Committee who approves research proposals
  - IRB Forms

<http://www.psychology.ilstu.edu/research/researchers.html>

# Protection of Human Rights - IRB

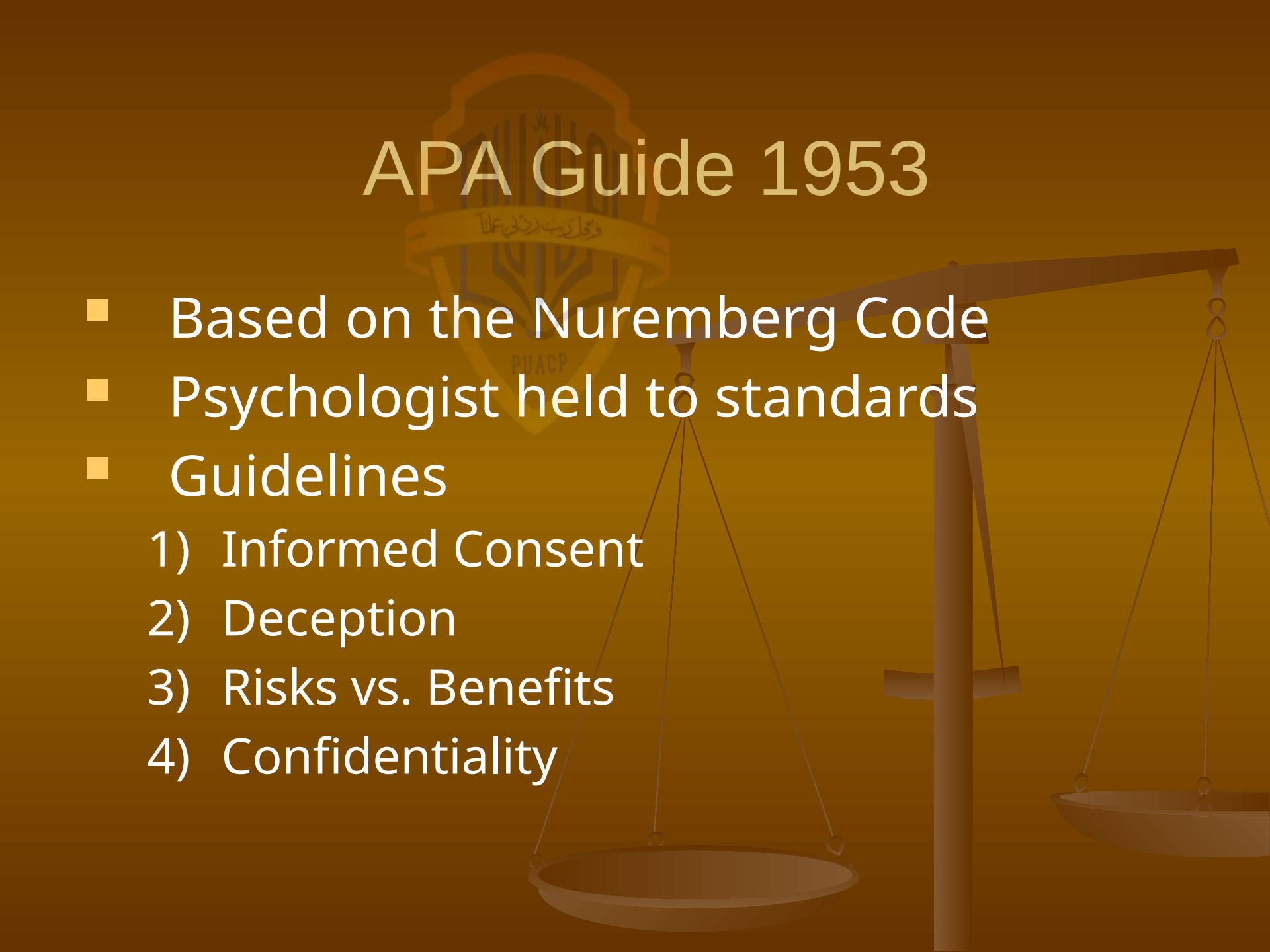
## ■ IRB Criteria

- Minimize risk
- Benefits > Risks
- Equal opportunity sampling
- Informed consent
- Documentation of consent
- Data monitoring
- Privacy & Confidentiality





# APA Guide 1953



- Based on the Nuremberg Code
- Psychologist held to standards
- Guidelines
  - 1) Informed Consent
  - 2) Deception
  - 3) Risks vs. Benefits
  - 4) Confidentiality

# Ethical Responsibilities

The background of the slide is a solid dark brown color. In the center, there is a faint, light brown watermark of a university crest. The crest is shield-shaped with a banner across it containing Arabic script. Below the banner, the letters 'PUACP' are visible. To the right of the crest, there is a large, stylized illustration of a balance scale, also in a light brown color. The scale is tilted, with the right pan being higher than the left pan.

- Researcher responsibilities
  - to science
  - to participants
  
- Examples of unethical behaviors
  - fabrication of results
  - harming participants

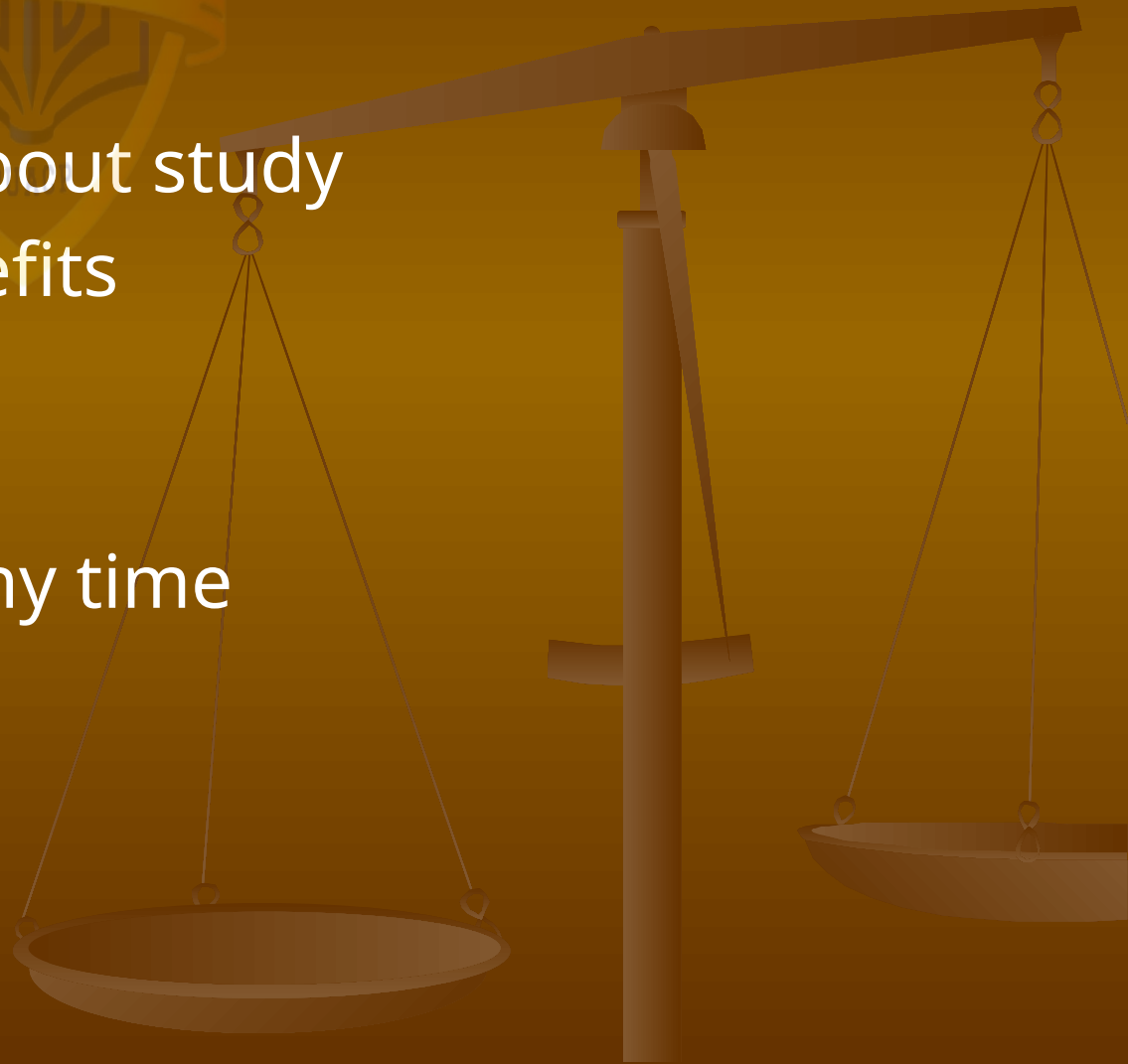
# Ethical Issues

The background of the slide is a solid dark brown color. In the center, there is a faint, stylized illustration of a balance scale, symbolizing ethical weighing. To the left of the scale, there is a faint, circular crest or seal, likely representing a university or institution, with Arabic calligraphy and a banner across it.

- No harm
  - Psychological or physical
  - If P is harmed, benefit > cost
    - e.g., an effective treatment with side effects

# Ethical Issues

- Informed Consent
  - Information about study
  - Risks and benefits
  - Voluntary
  - No coercion
  - Withdraw at any time



# Ethical Issues: Informed Consent

## Content

Surveys conducted by the Indiana University Center for Survey Research contain the following informed-consent components in their introductions:

1. Introduce ourselves—interviewer's name and Indiana University Center for Survey Research.
2. Briefly describe the survey topic (e.g., barriers to health insurance).
3. Describe the geographic area we are interviewing (e.g., people in Indiana) or target sample (e.g., aerospace engineers).
4. Tell who the sponsor is (e.g., National Endowment for the Humanities).
5. Describe the purpose(s) of the research (e.g., satisfaction with services received/provided by a local agency).
6. Give a "good-faith" estimate of the time required to complete the interview.
7. Promise anonymity and confidentiality (when appropriate).
8. Tell the participant the participation is voluntary.
9. Tell the participant that item-nonresponse is acceptable.
10. Ask permission to begin.

## Sample Introduction

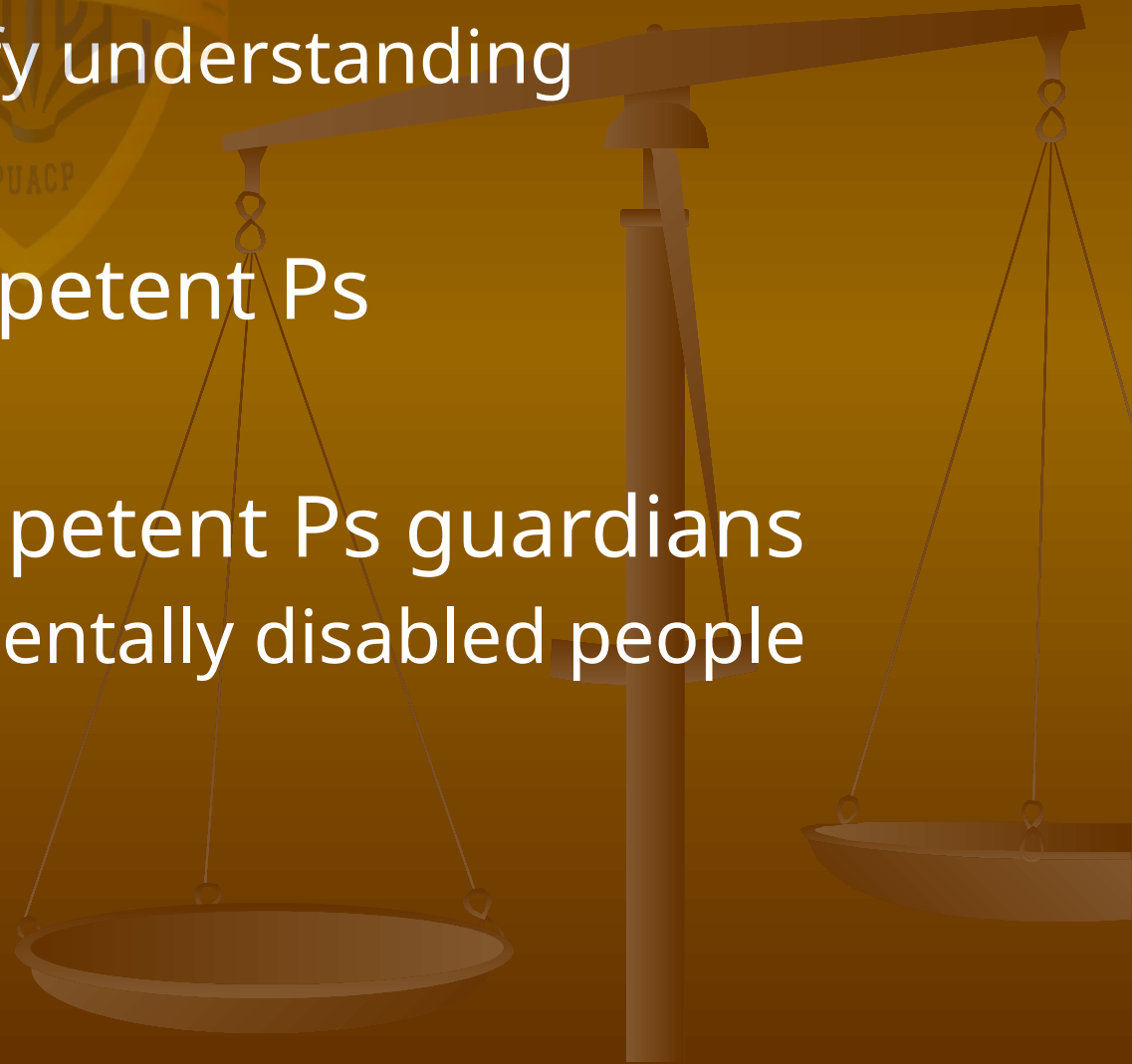
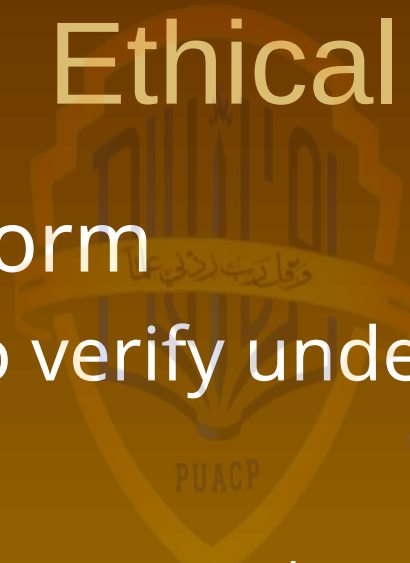
Hello, I'm [fill in NAME] from the Center for Survey Research at Indiana University. We're surveying Indianapolis area residents to ask their opinions about some health issues. This study is sponsored by the National Institutes of Health and its results will be used to research the effect of community ties on attitudes toward medical practices. The survey takes about 40 minutes. Your participation is anonymous and voluntary, and all your answers will be kept completely confidential. If there are any questions that you don't feel you can answer, please let me know and we'll move to the next one. So, if I have your permission, I'll continue.

## Sample Conclusion

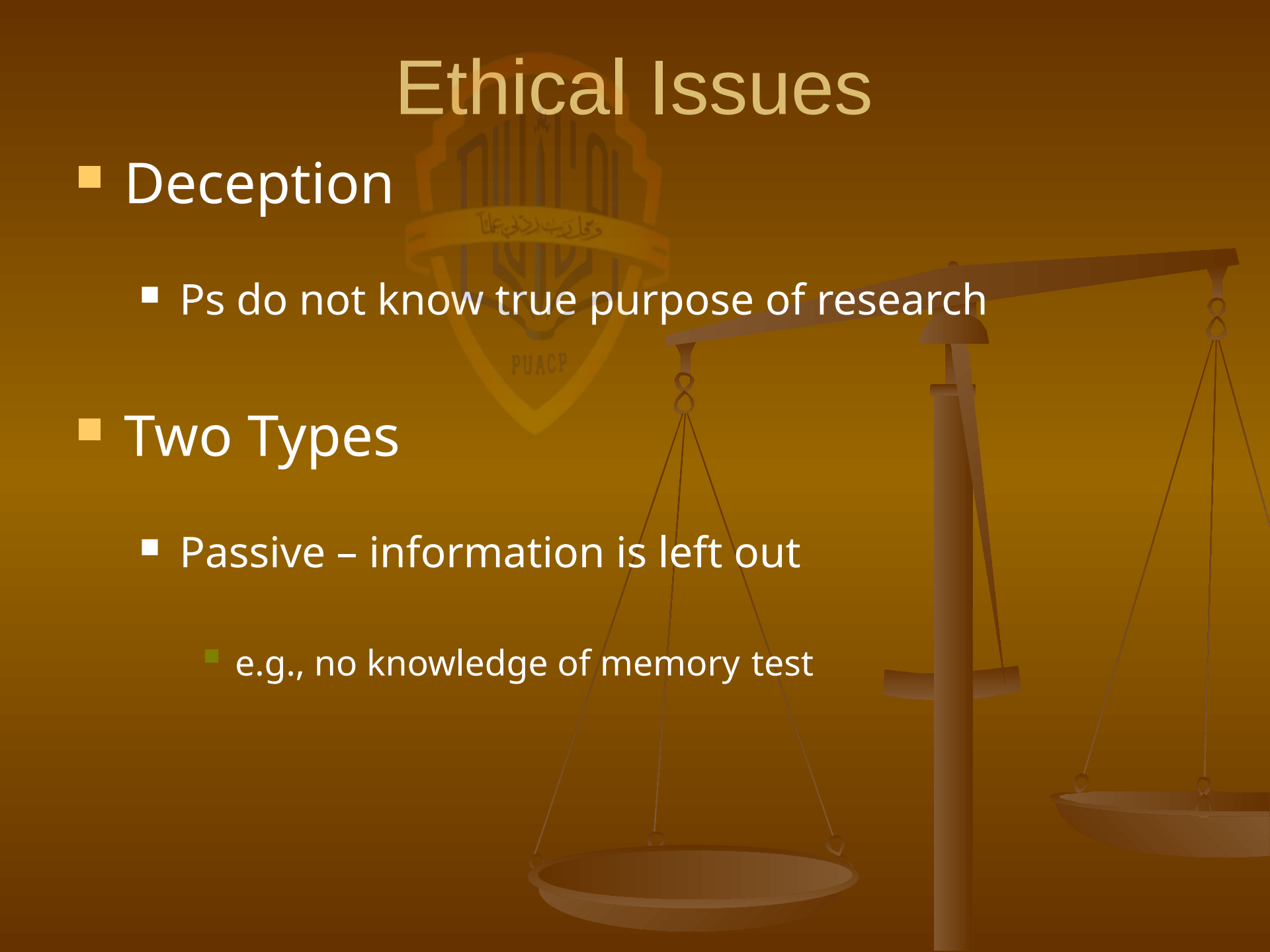
The participant is given information on how to contact the principal investigator. For example: John Kennedy is the principal investigator for this study. Would you like Dr. Kennedy's address or telephone number in case you want to contact him about the study at any time?

# Ethical Issues

- Consent Form
  - Ps sign to verify understanding
- Consent – competent Ps
- Assent – incompetent Ps guardians
  - e.g., developmentally disabled people



# Ethical Issues

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- Deception

- Ps do not know true purpose of research

- Two Types

- Passive – information is left out
    - e.g., no knowledge of memory test

# Ethical Issues

- Active – information is inaccurate
  - e.g., cover story
  - Milgram (1965)
  - Confederate - role-plays.

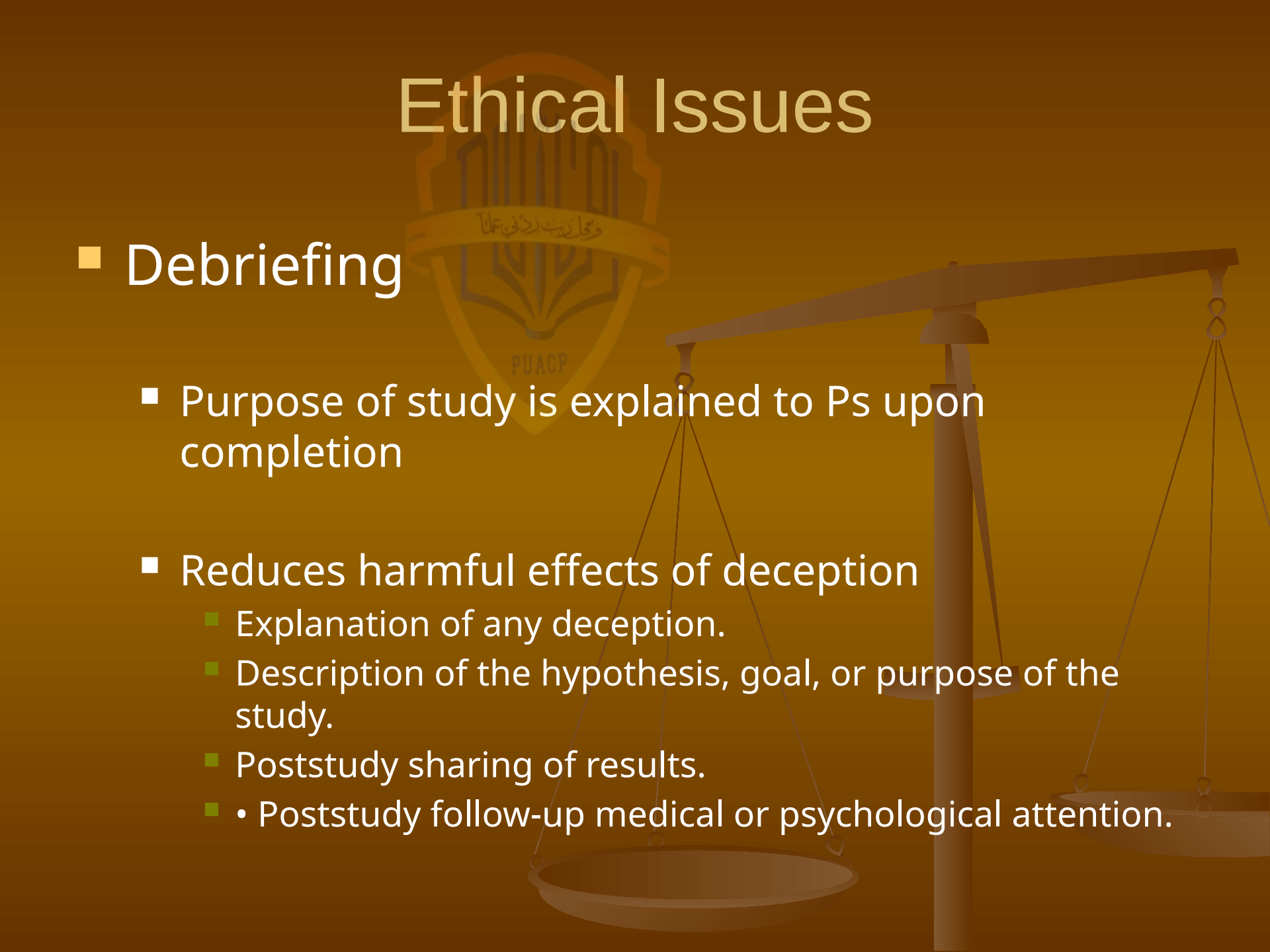
خول اتر اتمہارا تو ظاہر ہوا  
پیشہ ور قاتلو! تم سپاہی نہیں  
اب سبھی بے ضمیروں کے سرچاہیں  
اب فقط مسئلہ تاج شاہی نہیں۔

احمد فراز





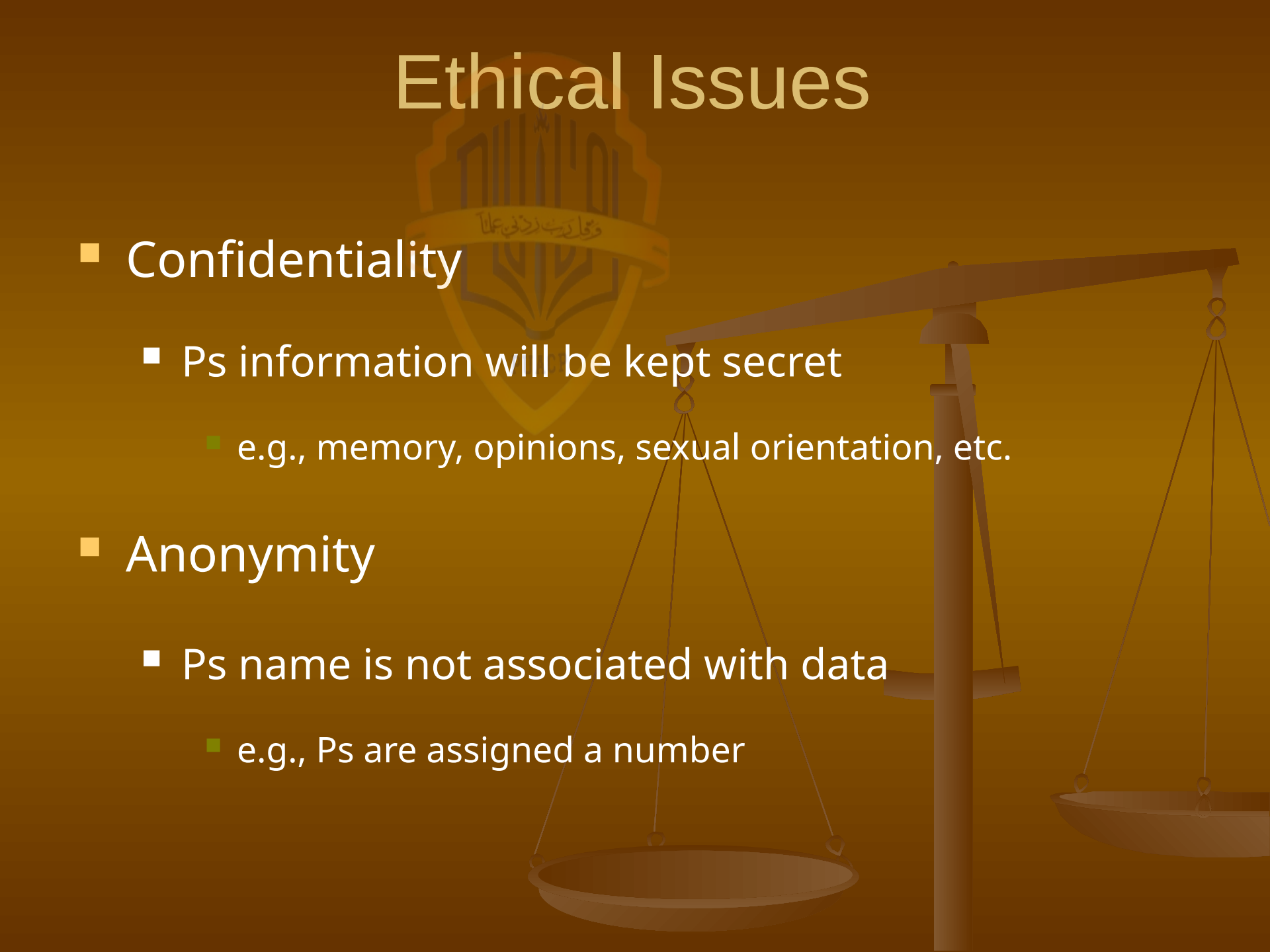
# Ethical Issues



## ■ Debriefing

- Purpose of study is explained to Ps upon completion
- Reduces harmful effects of deception
  - Explanation of any deception.
  - Description of the hypothesis, goal, or purpose of the study.
  - Poststudy sharing of results.
  - • Poststudy follow-up medical or psychological attention.

# Ethical Issues

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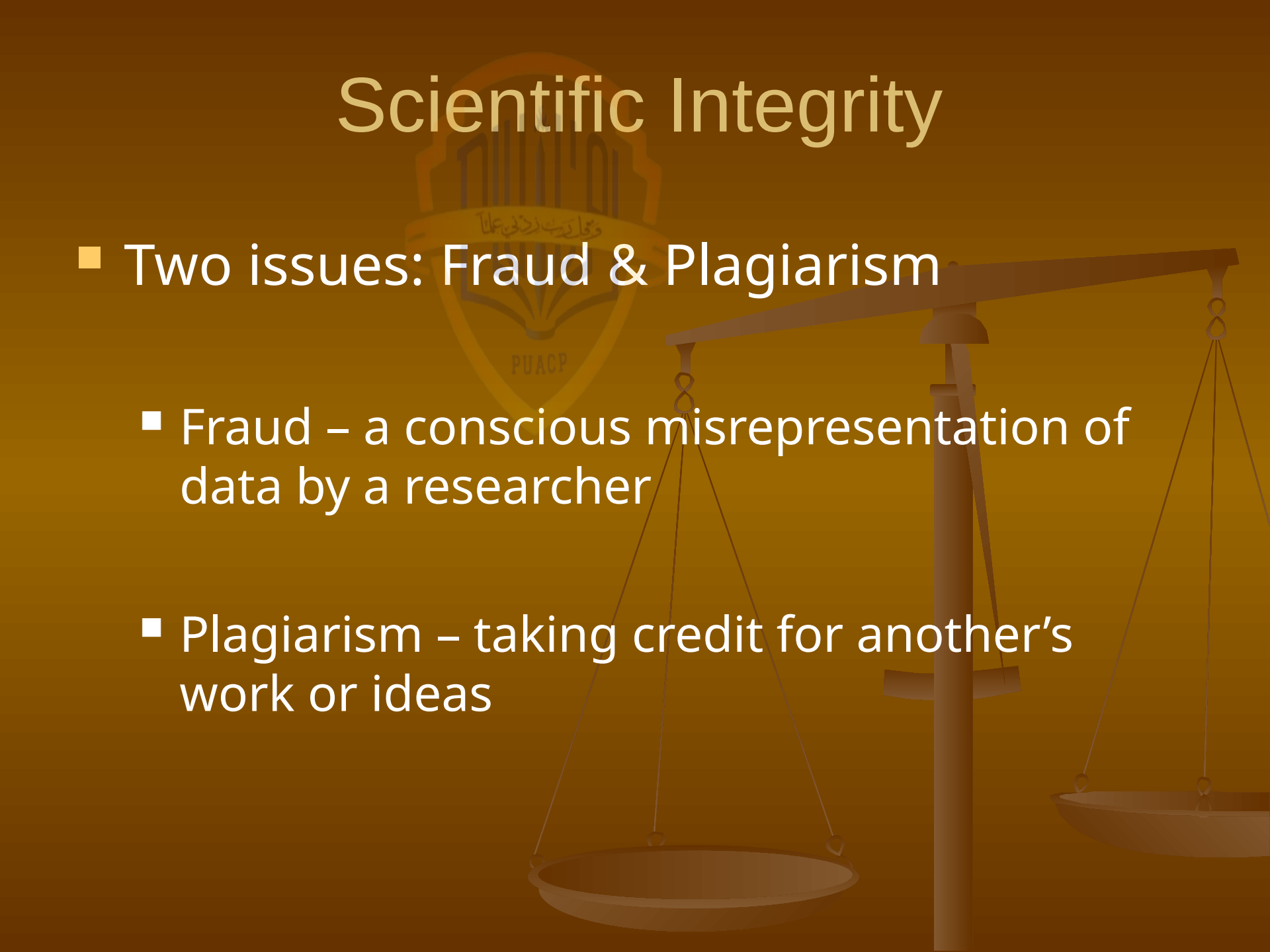
- Confidentiality

- Ps information will be kept secret
  - e.g., memory, opinions, sexual orientation, etc.

- Anonymity

- Ps name is not associated with data
  - e.g., Ps are assigned a number

# Scientific Integrity

The background of the slide is a solid dark brown color. In the center, there is a faint, light brown watermark. It consists of a shield-shaped crest on the left, which contains a stylized open book and the acronym 'PUACP' below it. To the right of the crest is a large, detailed illustration of a balance scale, symbolizing justice or integrity. The scale's beam is tilted, with the right pan hanging lower than the left.

- Two issues: Fraud & Plagiarism
  - Fraud – a conscious misrepresentation of data by a researcher
  - Plagiarism – taking credit for another's work or ideas

# Make Ethical Choices!!!

